

# THEMBA PHIRI

IT Service Desk Agent | Johannesburg, Gauteng | 0780661826 | p.themba3468@gmail.com

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## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

IT Service Desk professional with 3 years' experience as a first-line escalation point for a national user base, resolving 25+ tickets daily while maintaining SLA targets and delivering clear, customer-first communication across high-pressure, multi-site environments. Comfortable owning escalated tickets end-to-end and quickly adapting to new ticketing platforms, tools, and industries. Background includes hands-on support of Microsoft 365, Active Directory, and networked infrastructure (DNS, DHCP, VPNs, 3CX), with Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) and dual Fortinet Cybersecurity certifications, and MD-102: Microsoft 365 Endpoint Administrator in progress. Currently based in Johannesburg, willing to relocate. Eager to bring strong helpdesk and escalation experience into new industries.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### IT Service Desk Agent — Level 2 (24/7 Shift Support), Lancet Laboratories, Johannesburg

*Aug 2024 – Present*

- Serve as the sole first-line escalation point nationally during shift hours, supporting all Lancet Laboratories users across South Africa with complex infrastructure, network, and Microsoft-related incidents.
- Liaise across Development, Consultants, Data, On-site Technical, and relevant service provider teams to keep all Lancet internal systems running at optimal performance and reduce downtime.
- Resolve 25+ tickets daily, with 70% being escalations from Level 1 technicians, handling the most complex and time-sensitive incidents across multiple sites.
- Manage 5+ Active Directory changes daily, including user accounts, access rights, and permissions across the environment.
- Deploy and configure 8+ hardware/software installations weekly for end-users, including desktop computers, laptops, printers, WiFi routers, and Kodak scanners.
- Drove measurable improvements in average ticket resolution time through proactive troubleshooting and thorough root-cause documentation.
- Consistently ranked in the top 3 performers on monthly service desk statistics for ticket throughput and resolution quality.
- Co-authored standard operating procedures (SOPs) for common service desk incidents, documenting consistent troubleshooting steps to reduce resolution time and support faster onboarding of new technicians.

### IT Service Desk Agent — Level 1, Lancet Laboratories, Johannesburg

*Dec 2023 – Jul 2024*

- Logged, tracked, and resolved technical incidents using Hornbill ITSM and Kaseya Autotask, maintaining accurate documentation and timely follow-up.
- Administered the Microsoft 365 suite (Exchange, SharePoint, Teams, OneDrive, Outlook) for end-user support across the organisation.
- Managed user account lifecycle, password resets, and access provisioning in Active Directory in line with access management policy.
- Educated end-users on IT security best practice and system functionality, supporting compliance with company security policy.

### IT Intern, Lancet Laboratories, Johannesburg

*Apr 2023 – Nov 2023*

- Assisted senior IT staff with daily support tasks, infrastructure projects, and system maintenance activities within an enterprise, multi-site IT environment.
- Gained hands-on exposure to ticketing processes, systems installation support, and cross-team problem resolution.

## EDUCATION

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### Diploma in Information & Communications Technology — Average: 73%

*Durban University of Technology | Feb 2020 – Nov 2022*

**Modules:** Information Systems, Applications Development, Project Management, Cisco Networking & Cybersecurity Fundamentals, Mobile Computing

### MD-102: Microsoft 365 Endpoint Administrator — In Progress

*Microsoft Certification*

## LICENCES & CERTIFICATIONS

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- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) — Foundational certification covering core cloud concepts, Microsoft Azure services, security, and pricing.
- Fortinet Certified Fundamentals: Cybersecurity (FCF) — Entry-level certification covering foundational cybersecurity concepts, threats, and Fortinet security solutions.
- Fortinet Certified Associate: Cybersecurity (FCA) — Associate-level certification covering core cybersecurity concepts and Fortinet's Security Fabric.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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- Operating Systems: Windows 10/11
- Microsoft 365: Exchange Online, SharePoint, Teams, OneDrive, Outlook, MFA
- Azure & Identity: Microsoft Azure (AZ-900 certified), Entra ID, Intune (MD-102 in progress)
- Networking: DNS, DHCP, VPN, LAN/WLAN/WAN, TCP/IP, 3G, inter-office/multi-site connectivity
- Active Directory: User accounts, access rights, permissions management
- Infrastructure Support: Maintenance & patching, hardware/software deployment
- IT Security: Security updates, cybersecurity awareness, antivirus, risk assessment, compliance
- Backup & Recovery: Backup verification and disaster recovery support
- Remote Support: UltraVNC, TeamViewer
- Ticketing Systems: Hornbill ITSM, Kaseya Autotask — adapts quickly to new ticketing/CRM platforms
- Programming: Python, C#, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, SQL
- Asset Management: Hardware inventory and fixed asset tracking
- Mobile Device Management: Radix Vio MDM — deployed and administered software on company mobile devices

## KEY COMPETENCIES

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- Strong analytical and troubleshooting skills across networking, Microsoft 365, and endpoint environments
- Experienced supporting the full national user base across multiple sites simultaneously with shifting priorities
- Comfortable co-ordinating and training team members and end-users on new technologies and systems
- Proactive approach to IT security trends, patching, and continuous professional development
- Ability to support disaster recovery planning and backup verification processes
- Excellent communication skills with a customer-first approach in high-pressure, client-facing environments
- Adaptable and quick to learn new systems, tools, and technologies — comfortable transitioning into new industries and support environments

## REFERENCES

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Adharsh Ramdeen — Service Desk Supervisor, Lancet Laboratories

Franswua Van Staden — Cybersecurity Specialist, Lancet Laboratories

Judith Mohatle — Service Desk Supervisor & Mentor, Lancet Laboratories

*Contact details provided upon request.*